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EXPERIMENT 5

Designing a Business Dashboard in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create and deploy an interactive dashboard in Zoho Creator for monitoring and managing application data using widgets, charts, and reports, and to gain knowledge about the steps involved in designing a dashboard for a business application.

2. Introduction

A dashboard in Zoho Creator acts as a central visual panel that gives a quick overview of important data and performance indicators from an application. It helps users track key information using different components such as charts, summary cards, widgets, and navigation links. Dashboards support faster and better decision-making by presenting real-time data in a clear and organized manner. Zoho Creator offers an easy drag-and-drop interface to build dashboards and allows customization with various chart types, summary widgets, and links to forms and reports, making it suitable for many business applications.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To understand what a dashboard is and its importance in Zoho Creator.
- To learn the steps to create and configure a dashboard using different widgets and charts.
- To know how to add summary cards, graphs, and quick links.
- To explore the customization options for the dashboard layout.
- To develop a working dashboard for a real-time business scenario.

4. Procedure

- Sign in to the Zoho Creator account.
- Create a new application or open an existing application.
- Go to the Dashboard section and create a new dashboard.
- Add summary widgets to display important data such as total orders, total revenue, and total customers.
- Set appropriate data sources and aggregation methods for each widget.
- Insert chart widgets like bar charts, pie charts, and line charts to represent data trends.
- Configure the X-axis and Y-axis fields for the charts.
- Add quick links to related forms for easy data entry and navigation.
- Arrange and customize the layout to improve the visual appearance.
- Save and preview the dashboard to check its functionality.
- Make necessary changes if required.
- Publish the application after completing the dashboard design.

5. Illustrative Example

Let us consider an Online Book Store management system in which details about books, customers, orders, and payments are maintained using a Zoho Creator application.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

Create a dashboard for the Online Book Store application. Include summary widgets such as Total Books, Total Customers, Total Orders, and Total Revenue. Add a section showing the number of orders by payment method (UPI, Credit Card, Debit Card, Cash). Include quick links for adding new books, customers, and orders. Add charts such as "Books Sold by Category" (pie chart) and "Monthly Revenue Trend" (line chart). Store and display all information in real-time and generate reports to manage books, customers and orders efficiently.

5.2 Illustrative Form Design (Dashboard View)



6. Advantages and Limitations

6.1 Advantages

- Provides a complete view of key business information in one place.
- Visual representation of data makes analysis and decision-making easier.
- Real-time updates help in tracking the latest performance.
- Quick links allow faster navigation and data entry.
- Easy to build and customize using drag-and-drop components.
- Reduces manual reporting effort and saves time.

6.2 Limitations

- Advanced customization may require Deluge scripting.
- Performance can be slower with very large datasets.
- Some advanced chart types need extra configuration.
- The dashboard features are limited to the platform's capabilities.
- Highly complex enterprise requirements may need additional development.

7. Result

The experiment was completed successfully by creating and implementing a dashboard in Zoho Creator. The activity demonstrated how summary widgets, charts, quick links, and other components can be combined to build an interactive and user-friendly dashboard for a business application with minimal coding effort.